



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Founders Classical Academy: East Lewisville
School Website: <https://www.founderseastlewisville.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Founders Classical Academy - East Lewisville (FCA East Lewisville) presents itself publicly as a classical-education campus. However, based on the six-category classical rubric and explicit keyword indicators drawn from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School, the public materials on FCA East Lewisville show limited alignment with core classical practices beyond branding and a few programmatic breadcrumbs. The public materials reference a "classical approach to teaching" and offer typical school-community features (tours, events, fundraising, etc.) but do not clearly demonstrate engagement with Great Books, the Trivium/Quadrivium, formal Socratic pedagogy, Great Conversations, or the liturgical/theological dimensions highlighted in the classical-education rubric. Consequently, FCA East Lewisville is best described as NOT CLASSICAL in aggregate, with some SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL inflections in pedagogy/community-facing elements.

Key points driving the overall rating - Evidence of classical branding, but little explicit textual evidence of the six-element canon beyond "classical approach." This limits a full classical alignment across categories. For example, grades served (K–6) and several events/pages show a standard K–8/co-curricular flavor rather than a Grto-Grade-12 Great Books trajectory or Trivium/Quadrivium emphasis. See public materials noting "Grades Served: K-6" and the site's frequent reference to a "classical approach" without detailing Great Books or traditional classical curricula. - Pedagogical signals appear branded as classical (e.g., "School Tours," "classical approach to teaching"), but concrete, category-defining practices (Socratic seminars, scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation, imitation/mastery traditions, or the Great Books/Great Conversation elements) are not clearly documented on the public-facing pages. This yields a SOMEWHAT-leaning signal in Pedagogy but not a robust Classic signal in Curriculum or Pedagogy. See School Tours language emphasizing a "classical approach to teaching." - Parent/community signals exist (parent tours, information nights, fundraiser days), but the materials do not provide explicit evidence of parents as co-teachers or a formal, sustained "formation of affections" or "cultural transmission" program beyond general school-community events. This yields a partial alignment in Parents & Community but not a full Classical signal. See Parent Information Night and tours content.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations** — NOT CLASSICAL Evidence: The public materials do not provide theology, liturgical practice, or explicit metaphysical framing. What exists is branding around being "classical" rather than doctrinal or liturgical. The knowledge-base rubric emphasizes transcendental realism, theology, and liturgy as core indicators, which are not evidenced on FCA East Lewisville's public pages. Positive keywords related to transcendental realism or liturgical practice are not clearly present on the site; theological grounding is not explicit. See the site material indicating a general classical branding rather than theology or liturgy. Why this rating: Absence of explicit theological or liturgical framing; no liturgical/communal practices cited publicly. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, etc.) are not observed in explicit form on the public site; Negative indicators (secular humanism, value-neutral ethics, relativism) are not manifest, but the absence of the positive indicators is determinative. Score reflects absence of the core positive signals.

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- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL Evidence:** The campus branding emphasizes a “classical approach,” but there is no explicit documentation of formation toward virtue/wisdom or the traditional transcendent aims (truth/goodness/beauty) in the public content. The site’s public materials do not clearly articulate formation toward wisdom or human excellence as the telos of education. See the emphasis on a classical branding rather than a stated virtuous formation goal. Why this rating: Lacks explicit articulation of formation toward virtue and transdisciplinary aims; no direct statements about the true/good/beautiful as telos appear in public-facing copy. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords for this category include “formation,” “virtue,” “wisdom,” “pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty,” etc. These are not clearly present in FCA East Lewisville’s public materials. Negative signals (e.g., job/work-readiness or utilitarian framing) are not explicit, but the absence of the core classical telos cues leads to a Not Classical judgment here.
 - **Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL Evidence:** The public site emphasizes a “classical approach” but does not document the seven liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy), Great Books, or a Great Conversation in the FCA East Lewisville materials accessible publicly. The “Fourth Grade Field Trip” to Medieval Times and similar event content hints at a classical flavor but does not establish a canonical classical curriculum framework on public pages. See Fourth Grade Field Trip and general events content; the Great Books/Great Conversation references are not evidenced on the site. Why this rating: Without explicit mention of liberal-arts structure, Great Books, or the Trivium/Quadrivium across the curriculum, the category does not meet the core Curriculum signals of classical education. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals would include Great Books, seven liberal arts, Latin/Greek, and cross-disciplinary classical integration. Those explicit terms are not present on FCA East Lewisville’s public pages. The absence drives toward NOT CLASSICAL for this category.
 - **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** FCA East Lewisville publicly frames its method as “classical approach to teaching,” which aligns with the classical pedagogy framework’s emphasis on disciplined, historically grounded methods. However, the site does not publicly document Socratic seminars, scholé (restful learning), memorization/recitation, or imitation/mastery-era practices in its public copy. The presence of a stated classical approach signals some alignment, but the detailed pedagogical practices that define classical pedagogy (Socratic dialogue, memorization/recitation, restfulness, etc.) are not evidenced in the public content. See the School Tours language citing a “classical approach to teaching.” Why this rating: The explicit “classical approach to teaching” branding hints at classical pedagogy, but lack of explicit pedagogical practices (Socratic/dialogue, scholé, chant/memory work) in public materials keeps this category at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, not CLASSICAL. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals would include “Socratic dialogue,” “scholé/restful learning,” “recitation/memorization,” and “imitation/master-teacher models.” Not explicit on FCA East Lewisville’s site. The presence of branding alone yields a partial (somewhat) alignment; absence of the detailed pedagogical lexicon prevents a full Classical ranking.
 - **Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL Evidence:** The site lists individual staff pages (e.g., Nicole Steele, Nina Gonzalez, Marla Larimore, etc.) but does not publicize a “living curriculum” or “portrait of a teacher” or a formal faculty-cultivation ethos as per the classical model. The public-facing content presents a standard staff roster rather than a living-teacher-curriculum model. See staff listings and contact pages. Why this rating: The “faculty as living curriculum” and “portrait of what a teacher should be” signals in the classical rubric are not publicly documented on FCA East Lewisville’s pages. The evidence suggests typical school staffing rather than a classical faculty-culture portrayal. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords in this category include “living curriculum,” “model teachers,” and “portrait of a teacher.” Not observed in FCA East Lewisville’s public content. The absence yields NOT CLASSICAL for this category.
 - **Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** FCA East Lewisville presents parent-facing events (Parent Information Night), invites tours, and public fundraising/family engagement (North Texas Giving Day). These signals indicate a partnership with families and an opening of the campus to parental involvement. The “Parent Information Night” copy and the “School

Tours” content show explicit parent-facing engagement. See Parent Information Night and School Tours content. Why this rating: The presence of parent-facing events and accessible, open-campus touchpoints aligns with some of the Positive Keyword indicators for Parents & Community (partnership with families, parent formation, and open-campus visitation). However, the content does not demonstrate a full, policy-level, continuous co-teaching relationship or formal family formation programming, so it remains a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signal rather than CLASSICAL. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include “Partnership with Families,” “parent formation,” and “open campus visits.” The FCA East Lewisville site shows parent nights and tours that align with these concepts, though not in a fully codified, ongoing program, which yields a SOMEWHAT result.

Overall aggregate classification: NOT CLASSICAL - The six-category analysis yields two SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals (Pedagogy and Parents & Community) and four NOT CLASSICAL signals (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Faculty). The aggregate ranking, therefore, is NOT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - If FCA East Lewisville wanted to move toward CLASSICAL, the following concrete steps would most strongly shift the rubric: - Curriculum: Document and implement a liberal-arts spine that includes the Trivium and Quadrivium, Great Books/primary sources, Latin (or classical languages), and integration of history with literature and philosophy. Publicly publish a detailed curriculum map referencing Great Books and a canonical Western canon alongside historical depth. - Pedagogy: Publish explicit, classroom-level descriptions of pedagogical practices aligned with classical education, including Socratic seminars, scholé-inspired restful learning blocks, memorization/recitation (chanting/poetry), and imitation/mastery models across grade bands. - Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: If the school intends a religious dimension, clearly articulate the theological/theistic framework and its integration with the curriculum (while respecting non-sectarian vs. sectarian goals, as applicable). Publicly reference liturgy, ceremony, or communal worship practices if part of the model. - Faculty: Develop and publish a “living curriculum” portrait of teacher-mentors, with professional development in classical pedagogy, and explicitly describe mentorship and collegiality structures among faculty. - Parents & Community: Expand formal parent-partnership programs (co-teaching opportunities, family catechesis or shared classical readings, parent book clubs, and guided home-learning rhythms) and clearly articulate how parents participate as co-educators. - Public communications: Regularly publish progress on classical-curriculum goals (e.g., annual classical framework updates, Great Conversation topics, classical texts read, and student performances in public channels).

ABSTRACT - FCA East Lewisville’s public-facing materials position the campus as classical in branding but lack explicit, category-defining evidence for a full Classical School evaluation across all six rubric categories. The site emphasizes a “classical approach to teaching” and offers typical school-community features (tours, events, parent information nights, fundraising), but does not publicly document Great Books/Great Conversation, the Trivium/Quadrivium, or the full liturgical/theological or “living curriculum” facets outlined in the classical-education rubric. The six-category keyword analysis yields NOT CLASSICAL overall, with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals in Pedagogy and Parents & Community, largely due to the explicit branding and parent-facing programs. See the school site materials for: “Grades Served: K-6” and “School Tours” referencing a classical approach, as well as event and parent-night content.

Notes on sources - Public FCA East Lewisville site content used to ground the keyword analysis and category scoring includes: “Contact Us” with Grades Served: K-6; “School Tours” page describing a classical approach to teaching; various Events pages (Middle School Homecoming Dance; Fourth Grade Field Trip to Medieval Times; North Texas Giving Day) demonstrating programmatic and community signals. These items are visible in the Edlio/Founders East Lewisville crawl data and associated firecrawl files.

- The expertise for the classical rubric comes from the knowledge base materials: Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) doc (Positive/Negative keyword indicators for each category) and the Lexicon (classicality_lexicon) that anchors the keywords used in the analysis. See the Positive/Negative keywords for each category and for the relevant lexicon (e.g., Religious/Metaphysical Foundations; Pedagogy; etc.).

ABSTRACT (final section) - FCA East Lewisville’s public-facing materials align with a classical branding in pedagogy but do not demonstrate the full spectrum of classical education practices defined by the Six Essential Elements rubric. The school shows SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals in Pedagogy and Parents &

Community (through explicit “classical approach” language and parent-facing activities), but the absence of explicit Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, sustained liturgical/theological programs, and a living-curriculum teacher model places it in NOT CLASSICAL overall. The Six Elements framework and keyword indicators support this mixed profile, with strong branding but limited public documentation of canonical classical practices beyond branding. FCA East Lewisville would need to publicly document and implement full liberal-arts curriculum, explicit Socratic pedagogy, and a teacher-as-mentor living curriculum to move into the CLASSICAL category.

End of Abstract.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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